

FABRICATED DOCUMENT — TEST FIXTURE

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Hartwell Foundation

Education Innovation Grants — Request for Proposals

Cycle: Fall 2026 **Reference code:** HF-EIG-26F

1. Purpose

The Hartwell Foundation funds small, evidence-building grants that adapt existing, classroom-tested instructional interventions for under-resourced school settings — particularly rural districts, small charter networks, and districts with limited access to specialist coaching staff. We are not a general K-12 funder; we fund adaptation and rigorous small-scale evaluation of things that have already shown promise elsewhere, not the invention of new curricula from scratch.

2. Eligibility

Eligible applicants:

- Nonprofit research or teacher-education institutions (colleges of education, independent education-research nonprofits);
- Public school districts or regional education service agencies applying in partnership with a research lead.

The Principal Investigator must have prior experience running a classroom-based intervention study (pilot or full-scale). First-time PIs must name a co-PI or senior personnel member who meets this bar.

Any project involving data collection from students under 18 must include appropriate human-subjects review. See Section 7.

3. Priority Areas

For Fall 2026, the Foundation is prioritizing proposals in:

- Elementary and middle-grades mathematics, particularly fraction and proportional reasoning;
- Early literacy intervention for multilingual learners;
- Adaptation of specialist-coaching-dependent interventions for paraprofessional or lower-touch delivery models.

Proposals outside these three areas will not be considered in this cycle.

4. Award Amount and Duration

- **Maximum award:** \$85,000 total.
- **Duration:** single project year (up to 12 months from award start).
- The Foundation does not fund multi-year commitments through this program; renewal is possible but requires a full new application.

Applications requesting more than \$85,000 in total costs will be declined without panel review.

5. Format and Word Limits

- Combined narrative (Abstract through Approach) must not exceed **3,000 words**, excluding budget, references, and attachments.
- No page-limit or font requirement is imposed; word count governs.
- Submit as a single PDF.
- Tables and figures are exempt from the word count but should be used sparingly; a narrative that relies on tables to circumvent the word limit may be returned for reformatting.

6. Required Sections

Use the following headings, in order:

1. Title
2. PI/Institution
3. Abstract
4. Aims
5. Background & Prior Work
6. Approach
7. Evaluation Plan — how the project will measure whether the adaptation worked, including the specific instrument(s) used and the comparison or baseline condition.
8. Budget

7. Required Attachments

- **IRB Approval Letter or Exempt-Determination Letter.** Any project collecting data from students, teachers, or classrooms must include either an IRB approval letter or a formal exempt-determination letter from the applicant institution's IRB (or a partner institution's IRB operating under an existing agreement). Proposals describing student-level data collection without this attachment will be considered non-compliant and will not advance to panel review.
- **Letter of Support from each partner district**, confirming willingness to participate and, where applicable, existing relationships (e.g., through a regional education service agency).
- **One-page CV** for the PI (co-PI CV also required if named per Section 2).

8. Prohibited Content

- Undisclosed AI-generated narrative presented as original applicant analysis.
- Citations to sources that cannot be independently verified.

- Claims of statistical significance without reporting the underlying sample size and effect size.
- Any request for indirect costs exceeding 10% of direct costs.

9. Review Criteria

Applications are scored by a review panel on evidence base for the underlying intervention, quality and feasibility of the proposed adaptation, strength of the evaluation design, and district partnership readiness. The Foundation does not publish a detailed weighted rubric for this program; panelists apply the criteria above holistically.

10. Deadline and Submission

- **Deadline:** October 1, 2026, 5:00 PM Central Time.
- Submit via the Foundation's portal: **grants.hartwellfoundation.example**.
- Late or emailed submissions are not accepted.

11. Contact

Mr. Desmond Okafor-Reyes Program Officer, K-12 Innovation Grants Hartwell Foundation 88 Millbrook Row Cedar Falls, IA 50613

Email: dokafor-reyes@hartwellfoundation.example Phone: (319) 555-0172

Questions must be submitted in writing at least ten business days before the deadline. The Foundation does not conduct pre-submission calls for this program.